

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12401711
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
Inventor(s)	Palvadeau; Erik et al.

Webtier as a service

Abstract

A method for automated web resource deployment is provided. The method comprises creating web resource publication requests, wherein each web resource publication request comprises a number of configuration changes necessary to publish a web resource, on a network, at a particular uniform resource location. A standard format, validation workflow, and an approval workflow are provided for automation of the web resource publication requests. Once validated and approved, web resource publication requests are automatically converted to API calls which are executed on backend servers to implement the configuration changes required in the environment without further human intervention.

Inventors: Palvadeau; Erik (Nanterre, FR), Vigot; Nicolas (Blagnac, FR), Tang; Marc (Nanterre, FR), Leblin; Emeric (Nanterre, FR), Ibos; Pierre (Blagnac, FR), Catalan; Thierry (Nanterre, FR)

Applicant: ADP, Inc. (Roseland, NJ)

Family ID: 1000008779073

Assignee: ADP, Inc. (Roseland, NJ)

Appl. No.: 18/732409

Filed: June 03, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250080602 A1	Mar. 06, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 18121381 20230314 US 12003570 child-doc US 18732409
continuation parent-doc US 17304898 20210628 US 11616827 child-doc US 18121381

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04L67/02 (20220101); H04L9/40 (20220101); H04L41/22 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04L67/02 (20130101); H04L63/029 (20130101); H04L41/22 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04L (67/02); H04L (63/029); H04L (41/22)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
8032940	12/2010	Dhanani	726/26	G06F 21/6218
9438599	12/2015	Yuhan	N/A	H04L 63/107
11616827	12/2022	Palvadeau	709/223	H04L 41/0806
12003570	12/2023	Palvadeau	N/A	H04L 67/34
2003/0167405	12/2002	Freund	709/223	H04L 63/20
2011/0173541	12/2010	Carlson	715/735	H04L 41/0879
2012/0102543	12/2011	Kohli	726/1	H04L 63/20
2014/0215028	12/2013	Donner	709/220	H04L 41/16
2015/0095468	12/2014	Benny	709/220	G06F 9/45558
2016/0328222	12/2015	Arumugam	N/A	G06F 8/61
2018/0159845	12/2017	Aronov	N/A	H04L 63/0435
2018/0324051	12/2017	Dias	N/A	G06Q 10/00
2019/0227856	12/2018	Xu	N/A	G06F 9/541
2019/0372844	12/2018	Moats	N/A	H04L 41/0806
2019/0386877	12/2018	Vaidya	N/A	H04L 41/5051
2019/0394286	12/2018	Chunduru Venkata	N/A	H04L 41/5048
2020/0073739	12/2019	Rungta	N/A	G06F 8/60
2020/0220875	12/2019	Harguindeguy	N/A	H04L 63/101
2021/0200814	12/2020	Tal	N/A	G06F 16/90335
2022/0417316	12/2021	Palvadeau	N/A	H04L 63/029
2023/0231900	12/2022	Palvadeau	709/223	H04L 67/34
2025/0080602	12/2024	Palvadeau	N/A	H04L 41/0806

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

US Corrected Notice of Allowance issued in corresponding U.S. Appl. No. 17/304,898, dated Dec. 21, 2022 (4 pages). cited by applicant

US Notice of Allowance issued in corresponding U.S. Appl. No. 17/304,898, dated Nov. 30, 2022 (7 pages). cited by applicant

US Notice of Allowance issued in corresponding U.S. Appl. No. 18/121,381, dated Jan. 29, 2024 (9 pages). cited by applicant

US Office Action issued in corresponding U.S. Appl. No. 17/304,898, dated May 11, 2022 (13 pages). cited by applicant

US Office Action issued in corresponding U.S. Appl. No. 17/304,898, dated Oct. 6, 2022 (12

Primary Examiner: Lazaro; David R

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Foley & Lardner LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority and benefit under 35 U.S.C. § 120 as a continuation of U.S. Ser. No. 17/304,898, filed Jun. 28, 2021, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in entirety.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

1. Field

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to an improved computer system and, in particular, to a method and system for an improved dedicated webservice protection layer and automated web resource deployment.

2. Background

(2) Many applications today instead of being compiled and installed on client computer systems are being deployed as a browser-based tool. These tools are then published to their audience internally via an organization's Intranet or externally via the public Internet. This method of application deployment creates security and configuration issues which are traditionally addressed by manual configuration and testing by specialized information technology teams. This process adds length to the deployment time and complexity to the deployment environment for standing up applications.

(3) Therefore, it would be desirable to have a method and apparatus that take into account at least some of the issues discussed above, as well as other possible issues.

SUMMARY

(4) An illustrative embodiment provides a computer-implemented method for web resource deployment. The method comprises receiving a web resource publication request from an authenticated client. The configuration change format in the received web resource publication request is validated through a workflow and approved for implementation. The approved web resource publication request is implemented by executing the requested configuration changes on a number of backend servers. This is accomplished by creating an appropriate application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request. The API call is sent to the appropriate backend servers for execution. A number of API call responses comprised of the execution results of the API call to the backend servers are received. The implemented configuration changes are stored in a version control central repository. The received API call responses are stored in a repository. A status for the web resource publication request is determined based on the stored API call responses. The evaluated web resource publication request status is sent to the authenticated client.

(5) Another illustrative embodiment provides a system for web resource deployment. The system comprises a bus system, a storage device connected to the bus system, wherein the storage device stores program instructions, and a number of processors connected to the bus system, wherein the number of processors execute the program instructions to: receive a web resource publication request from an authenticated client; validate the format of the web resource publication request; approve the implementation of the web resource publishing request; execute configuration changes on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to

the web resource publication request; receive a number of API call responses from the backend servers in response to the web resource publication request; store configuration changes on a version control central repository; store the API call response; determine a request status of the web resource publication request based on the stored API call responses; and send the request status to the authenticated client.

(6) Another illustrative embodiment provides a computer program product for web resource deployment. The computer program product comprises a computer-readable storage medium having program instructions embodied thereon to perform the steps of: receiving a web resource publication request from an authenticated client; validating the format of the web resource publication request; approving the implementation of the web resource publishing request; executing configuration changes on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request; receiving a number of API call responses from the backend servers in response to the web resource publication request; storing configuration changes on a version control central repository; storing the API call response; determining a request status of the web resource publication request based on the stored API call responses; and sending the request status to the authenticated client.

(7) The features and functions can be achieved independently in various embodiments of the present disclosure or may be combined in yet other embodiments in which further details can be seen with reference to the following description and drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The novel features believed characteristic of the illustrative embodiments are set forth in the appended claims. The illustrative embodiments, however, as well as a preferred mode of use, further objectives and features thereof, will best be understood by reference to the following detailed description of an illustrative embodiment of the present disclosure when read in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 is a pictorial representation of a network of data processing systems in which illustrative embodiments may be implemented;

(3) FIG. 2 is an illustration of a block diagram of an application development environment in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(4) FIG. 3 is an illustration of a request flow from client to target web resource in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(5) FIG. 4 is an illustration of an application development environment client user interface screen in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(6) FIG. 5 is an illustration of a WebTier as a Service request flow overview in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(7) FIG. 6 is an illustration of WebTier as a Service environment overview in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(8) FIG. 7 is a flowchart for a process of creating a WebTier as a Service system in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(9) FIG. 8 depicts a flowchart for a process of managing the incoming configuration requests in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(10) FIG. 9 depicts a flowchart for a process of executing configuration changes on a web server via a WebServ API call in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(11) FIG. 10 depicts a flowchart for a process of executing configuration changes on a Virtual IP Address (VIP) server via a VIP API call in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(12) FIG. 11 depicts a flowchart for a process of executing configuration changes on a certificate

store server via a CERT API call in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
(13) FIG. 12 depicts a flowchart for a process of executing configuration changes on a Domain Name Services (DNS) server via a DNS API call in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
(14) FIG. 13 depicts a flowchart for a process of executing configuration changes on a firewall server via a firewall API call in accordance with an illustrative embodiment; and
(15) FIG. 14 is an illustration of a block diagram of a data processing system in accordance with an illustrative embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(16) The illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account one or more different considerations. For example, the illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account that typically multiple information technology support teams must manually design, configure, and test web resource deployments to ensure the security and integrity of the application and the networks they support. This is normally a time and labor intensive process which adds days or weeks to the web-based application deployment process. The illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account are security issues, especially for Internet deployed, public facing web applications which is why specialized tools and teams are typically required to deploy them.

(17) The illustrative embodiments also recognize and take into account that web application developers do not have an easy way to securely and quickly deploy their web applications themselves once completed and must rely on others to manually intervene on their behalf. As a result, this reliance on others also slows down deployment of changes in existing web-based applications, since the change in the application can require going through the entire deployment process again.

(18) The illustrative embodiments provide a self-service automation method that allows web-based application developers to submit web resource publication requests for automated review and implementation. A developer can create a web resource publication request through a user interface or through a programmatic API call. The interactive and programmatic interfaces allow application developers to create uniform resource locators (URLs), modify URLs, delete URLs, create uniform resource identifiers (URIs), modify URIs, delete URIs, create services, modify services, delete services, create LDAP entries, modify LDAP entries, delete LDAP entries, and validate subscriptions to web resources.

(19) The web resource publication request format is verified and goes through an approval workflow. Once verified and approved, the configuration changes required by the web resource publication request are executed on backend servers which managing those sections of the network environment via application programming interface (API) calls to the appropriate backend server. The backend server executes the requested change and returns a status. The successful execution of the API call implements the configuration changes implemented, which allows for deployment level changes to network environments to be implemented and online within minutes instead of days.

(20) The completed configuration changes are maintained in a version control central repository for data analysis and reporting purposes. Version control is maintained by storing a first file on the version control central repository, which represents the current configuration changes. If no file exists representing previous configuration changes, the first file is stored as a new file for a change type represented by the current configuration changes, and a new version number is associated with the new file. If a second file exists representing previous configuration changes, the first file is stored as a replacement file for a change type represented by the configuration changes. A new version number is associated with the new file, where the new version number equals an old version number of the second file incremented by a predefined value.

(21) With reference to FIG. 1, a pictorial representation of a network of data processing systems is depicted in which illustrative embodiments may be implemented. Network data processing system **100** is a network of computers in which the illustrative embodiments may be implemented.

Network data processing system **100** contains network **102**, which is the medium used to provide communications links between various devices and computers connected together within network data processing system **100**. Network **102** might include connections, such as wire, wireless communication links, or fiber optic cables.

(22) In the depicted example, server computer **104** and server computer **106** connect to network **102** along with storage unit **108**. In addition, client devices **110** connect to network **102**. In the depicted example, server computer **104** provides information, such as boot files, operating system images, and applications to client devices **110**. Client devices **110** can be, for example, computers, workstations, or network computers. As depicted, client devices **110** include client computers **112**, **114**, and **116**. Client devices **110** can also include other types of client devices such as mobile phone **118**, tablet computer **120**, and smart glasses **122**.

(23) In this illustrative example, server computer **104**, server computer **106**, storage unit **108**, and client devices **110** are network devices that connect to network **102** in which network **102** is the communications media for these network devices. Some or all of client devices **110** may form an Internet of things (IoT) in which these physical devices can connect to network **102** and exchange information with each other over network **102**.

(24) Client devices **110** are clients to server computer **104** in this example. Network data processing system **100** may include additional server computers, client computers, and other devices not shown. Client devices **110** connect to network **102** utilizing at least one of wired, optical fiber, or wireless connections.

(25) Program code located in network data processing system **100** can be stored on a computer-recordable storage medium and downloaded to a data processing system or other device for use. For example, the program code can be stored on a computer-recordable storage medium on server computer **104** and downloaded to client devices **110** over network **102** for use on client devices **110**.

(26) In the depicted example, network data processing system **100** is the Internet with network **102** representing a worldwide collection of networks and gateways that use the Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) suite of protocols to communicate with one another. At the heart of the Internet is a backbone of high-speed data communication lines between major nodes or host computers consisting of thousands of commercial, governmental, educational, and other computer systems that route data and messages. Of course, network data processing system **100** also may be implemented using a number of different types of networks. For example, network **102** can be comprised of at least one of the Internet, an intranet, a local area network (LAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), or a wide area network (WAN). FIG. 1 is intended as an example, and not as an architectural limitation for the different illustrative embodiments.

(27) In the illustrative examples, the hardware may take the form of a circuit system, an integrated circuit, an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmable logic device, or some other suitable type of hardware configured to perform a number of operations. With a programmable logic device, the device may be configured to perform the number of operations. The device may be reconfigured at a later time or may be permanently configured to perform the number of operations. Programmable logic devices include, for example, a programmable logic array, programmable array logic, a field programmable logic array, a field programmable gate array, and other suitable hardware devices. Additionally, the processes may be implemented in organic components integrated with inorganic components and may be comprised entirely of organic components, excluding a human being. For example, the processes may be implemented as circuits in organic semiconductors.

(28) Turning to FIG. 2, a block diagram of an application development environment is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Application development environment **200** might be implemented in network data processing system **100** in FIG. 1.

(29) Application development environment **200** comprises a computer system **202**, authenticated

client **212**, and backend servers **232**. Computer system **202** is a physical hardware system and includes one or more data processing systems. When more than one data processing system is present in computer system **202**, those data processing systems are in communication with each other using a communications medium. The communications medium can be a network. The data processing systems can be selected from at least one of a computer, a server computer, a tablet computer, or some other suitable data processing system.

(30) Within the computer system **202** are a request processor **214**, an API call response storage **204**, and a version control repository for storing configuration changes **220** that are verified, approved, and implemented by the computer system **202**. The request processor manages a validation workflow **206**, an approval workflow **222**, and an execution engine **224**.

(31) An authenticated client **212** generates a web resource publication request **208** which has a specific request format **210** based on the type of web resource publication request **208** generated. The authenticated client **212** sends the web resource publication request **208** to the request processor **214** in computer system **202**. The web resource publication request **208** is sent through the validation workflow **206** by the request processor **214**. Once the web resource publication request **208** is successfully validated by the validation workflow **206** it is passed on to the approval workflow **222**. Once the web resource publication request **208** is successfully approved by the approval workflow **222** it is passed on to the execution engine **224**. If the validation workflow **206** or the approval workflow **222** fails, an appropriate web resource publication request status **216** is returned to the authenticated client **212**.

(32) The execution engine **224** converts validated and approved web resource publication requests **208** into an appropriate application programming interface (API) call **226**. The API call **226** comprises the requested configuration change **228** to be implemented. The API call **226** is sent to an appropriate backend server **232** for processing. If the configuration change **228** is successfully implemented by the backend server **232** then an appropriate API Call Response **230** is sent by the backend server **232** to the execution engine **224**. If the configuration change **228** is not implemented by the backend server **232** then an appropriate API Call Response **230** is sent by the backend server **232** to the execution engine **224**.

(33) The API Call response **230** received from the backend server **232** is stored in a repository for stored API Call responses **204**. Configuration changes **228** which are successfully implemented are converted by the execution engine **224** into an appropriate web resource publication request status **216**. The execution engine **224** then sends the web resource publication request status **216** to the authenticated client **212**. Configuration changes **228** which are successfully implemented are also sent by the execution engine **224** to the version control repository **218**. The version control repository **218** then creates a stored configuration change **220** based on the implemented configuration change **228**.

(34) Configuration changes **228** which are not successfully implemented are converted by the execution engine **224** into an appropriate web resource publication request status **216**. The execution engine **224** then sends the web resource publication request status **216** to the authenticated client **212**.

(35) Application development environment **200** can be implemented in software, hardware, firmware, or a combination thereof. When software is used, the operations performed by application development environment **200** can be implemented in program code configured to run on hardware, such as a processor unit. When firmware is used, the operations performed by application development environment **200** can be implemented in program code and data and stored in persistent memory to run on a processor unit. When hardware is employed, the hardware may include circuits that operate to perform the operations in application development environment **200**.

(36) In the illustrative examples, the hardware may take a form selected from at least one of a circuit system, an integrated circuit, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a

programmable logic device, or some other suitable type of hardware configured to perform a number of operations. With a programmable logic device, the device can be configured to perform the number of operations. The device can be reconfigured at a later time or can be permanently configured to perform the number of operations. Programmable logic devices include, for example, a programmable logic array, a programmable array logic, a field programmable logic array, a field programmable gate array, and other suitable hardware devices. Additionally, the processes can be implemented in organic components integrated with inorganic components and can be comprised entirely of organic components excluding a human being. For example, the processes can be implemented as circuits in organic semiconductors.

(37) These components can be located in computer system **202**, which is a physical hardware system and includes one or more data processing systems. When more than one data processing system is present in computer system **202**, those data processing systems are in communication with each other using a communications medium. The communications medium can be a network. The data processing systems can be selected from at least one of a computer, a server computer, a tablet computer, or some other suitable data processing system.

(38) Request processor **214** might comprise one or more processors. As used herein a processor unit is a hardware device and is comprised of hardware circuits such as those on an integrated circuit that respond and process instructions and program code that operate a computer. When request processor **214** executes instructions for a process, one or more processors can be on the same computer or on different computers in computer system **202**. In other words, the process can be distributed between processors on the same or different computers in computer system **202**. Furthermore, one or more processors comprising request processor **214** can be of the same type or different type of processors. For example, request processor **214** can be selected from at least one of a single core processor, a dual-core processor, a multi-processor core, a general-purpose central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), a digital signal processor (DSP), or some other type of processor.

(39) FIG. **3** depicts a flowchart for a process of managing request flows through a WebTier as a Service system in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in FIG. **3** can be implemented in hardware, software, or both. When implemented in software, the process can take the form of program code that is run by one of more processor units located in one or more hardware devices in one or more computer systems. Process **300** might be implemented in application development environment **200** shown in FIG. **2**.

(40) Process **300** begins by an authenticated client of the system initiating a web resource publication request (step **302**).

(41) In one illustrative embodiment, the web resource publication request can be manually reviewed by a number of teams, for validation and/or approvals before being submitted for technical validation and approval (step **304**). In another illustrative embodiment, the web resource publication request review and/or approval could be automated before the web resource publication request is submitted for technical validation and approval. In another illustrative embodiment, the need for the web resource publication request to be reviewed or approved before technical review submission could be eliminated.

(42) The web resource publication request is then submitted into the WebTier as a Service process for technical validation and approval (step **306**). In one illustrative embodiment, a number of information technology support teams review the web resource publication request and either approve or reject the web resource publication request (step **308**). In another illustrative embodiment, the web resource publication request's technical review and/or approval could be automated. In another illustrative embodiment, the rules for technical validation and approval of the web resource publication request could be implemented programmatically.

(43) Review and approval from a web environment support team may be required before the web resource publication request can advance (step **310**).

(44) Review and approval from a network environment support team may be required before the web resource publication request can advance (step **312**).

(45) Once all approvals are received, the configuration change requested by the web resource publication request is sent to a backend server as an implementation task via an application programming interface (API) call (step **324**).

(46) To process a web server configuration change, an API call is sent to an Apache configuration manager to implement the requested configuration change (step **314**).

(47) To process a web access configuration change, an API call is sent to an SiteMinder configuration manager to implement the requested configuration change (step **316**).

(48) To process a security certificate configuration change, an API call is sent to a certificate store manager to implement the requested configuration change (step **318**).

(49) To process a domain name services (DNS) configuration change, an API call is sent to a DNS configuration manager to implement the requested configuration change (step **320**).

(50) To process a Virtual IP (VIP) configuration change, an API call is sent to an VIP configuration manager to implement the requested configuration change (step **322**).

(51) Once all required configuration changes are completed, the fully configured web resource is brought online in the network environment (step **326**). Process **300** then ends.

(52) FIG. **4** is an illustration of a WebTier as a Service user interface allowing a web application developer to create a web resource publication request in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The user interface in the illustrative embodiment can be used to collect, verify, and validate data from a number of data fields required to create, modify, or delete the web resource publication request. The data fields can be populated from user input or retrieval of existing data values from one or more central repositories.

(53) FIG. **5** is an illustration of a request flowing through a WebTier as a Service environment from the web application developer to the completed URL in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Process **500** starts with a user generating a web resource publication request. In one illustrative embodiment, the user can access a user interface **400** shown in FIG. **4** to initiate the web resource publication request (step **502**).

(54) In a different illustrative embodiment, the user can use a programming language or a build management language to generate the web resource publication request and submit the web resource publication request directly to the backend API server (step **504**).

(55) A deployment services backend server accepts the web resource publication request and converts it to a backend server API call. The deployment services backend server then sends the API call to the appropriate backend server (step **506**).

(56) Apache web server API calls are sent to an Apache Configuration Request Server to implement. SiteMinder API calls are sent to a SiteMinder Configuration Request Server to implement (step **508**).

(57) Domain Name Services (DNS) API calls are sent to a DNS Configuration Request Server to implement (step **510**).

(58) Firewall API calls are sent to a Firewall Configuration Request Server to implement (step **512**).

(59) Virtual IP (VIP) API calls are sent to a VIP Configuration Request Server to implement (step **514**).

(60) Certificate API calls are sent to a Certificate Configuration Request Server to implement (step **516**).

(61) Once all configuration requests have been completed by the backend servers, the web resource can be marked ready for publication (step **518**). Process **500** then ends.

(62) FIG. **6** is an illustration of a WebTier as a Service environment in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The environment in FIG. **6** can be implemented in hardware, software, or both. When implemented in software, the process can take the form of program code that is run by

one of more processor units located in one or more hardware devices in one or more computer systems. Process **600** might be implemented in one or more of the server computers **104** shown in FIG. **1**. Process **600** might be implemented in application development environment **200** shown in FIG. **2**.

(63) A web resource publication request **602** is generated by a user within a user interface **400** shown in FIG. **4**. A list of available web resources **604** impacted by the web resource publication request **602** is requested from an execution engine **612** and sent to a deployment services backend server **614**.

(64) Information technology support teams **610** can submit web resource publication requests **602** through a user interface **400** shown in FIG. **4** or a programmatic API call to the execution engine **612** to process configuration changes in the environment.

(65) Network environment support teams **616** can submit web resource publication requests **602** through a user interface **400** shown in FIG. **4** or a programmatic API call to the execution engine **612** to process configuration changes in the environment.

(66) The web resource publication request **602** received by the execution engine **612** can also be put through an approval workflow **618** before being submitted to the deployment services backend server **614** for execution.

(67) The web resource publication request **602** is sent to the deployment services backend server **614** for conversion to a backend server API call representing a requested configuration change for execution on the backend server.

(68) The configuration change requested by the web resource publication request **602** is sent to the appropriate backend server for implementation either by the execution engine **612** directly to a backend server like SiteMinder **622** or through the deployment services backend server **614** to a backend server like Apache **624**.

(69) A change management central repository **606** records the requested, approved, and completed configuration changes to the environment. A version control central repository **620** stores the different versions of the configuration changes, API calls, and web resource publication requests **602** that are approved, implemented, and completed successfully in the environment. Process **600** then ends.

(70) FIG. **7** depicts a flowchart for a process of creating a WebTier as a Service system in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in FIG. **7** can be implemented in hardware, software, or both. When implemented in software, the process can take the form of program code that is run by one of more processor units located in one or more hardware devices in one or more computer systems. Process **700** might be implemented in application development environment **200** shown in FIG. **2**.

(71) Process **700** begins by receiving a web resource publication request from an authenticated client of the system (step **702**).

(72) The format of the web resource publication request received is validated (step **704**). Once the web resource publication request has been validated it is submitted for approval (step **706**). If the web resource publication request rejected, it is returned to the authenticated client with an appropriate web resource publication request status (step **718**). Process **700** then ends.

(73) If the web resource publication request is approved, it is sent to an execution engine to execute the requested configuration changes on a number of backend servers (step **708**). Before sending the web resource publication request to the backend server, the request is converted into an application programming interface (API) call appropriate for the backend server receiving the request.

(74) The backend server will send an API call response after it attempts to execute the API call. The backend server will format the API call response based on the success or failure of implementing the configuration change requested in the web resource publication request. The API call response will be sent back to the execution engine for further processing (step **710**).

(75) The execution engine stores the implemented configuration change in a version control central

repository (step **712**). The execution engine also stores the API call response received from the backend server (step **714**).

(76) Based on the API call response received and stored, a web resource publication request status for the web resource publication request is determined (step **716**). The determined web resource publication request status is sent to the authenticated client (step **718**). Process **700** then ends.

(77) FIG. **8** depicts a flowchart for a process of managing the incoming configuration requests in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Process **800** might be an additional process within steps **706** and **708** in FIG. **7**.

(78) Process **800** starts by a configuration request being received either through an API call from an authenticated client user interface (step **802**) or a programmatic API call (step **804**).

(79) The request is submitted for a technical review and approval (step **806**) by IT support, research and development, or other organizations placed in the validation or approval workflows. In one illustrative embodiment, the technical validation and approval are provided through user interface **400** shown in FIG. **4**. In another illustrative embodiment, the technical validation and approval are provided through a programmatic response using an API call.

(80) Approved Apache web server configuration requests are sent to an Apache Configuration Request Server to implement (step **808**).

(81) Approved SiteMinder configuration requests are sent to a SiteMinder Configuration Request Server to implement (step **812**).

(82) Approved Domain Name Services (DNS) server configuration requests are sent to a DNS Configuration Request Server to implement (step **816**).

(83) Approved Firewall configuration requests are sent to a Firewall Configuration Request Server to implement (step **810**).

(84) Approved Virtual IP (VIP) configuration requests are sent to a VIP Configuration Request Server to implement (step **812**).

(85) Approved Certificate configuration requests are sent to a Certificate Configuration Request Server to implement (step **818**).

(86) If the Uniform Resource Location (URL) is fully configured, meaning all required configuration requests have been successfully implemented by the appropriate request servers, then the URL is marked ready for use and brought online (step **820**). Process **800** then ends.

(87) With reference next to FIG. **9**, a flowchart or a process for executing configuration changes is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in the flowchart in FIG. **9** is an example of one implementation for step **708** in FIG. **7** in which configuration changes are executed on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request.

(88) As depicted, the approved web resource publication request is converted into an API call appropriate to the backend server, in this embodiment, a WebServ API call, required to execute the configuration change (step **902**). The WebServ API call is sent to a number of centralized API backend servers (step **904**). The WebServ API call is then sent to a number of WebServ backend servers, which execute the configuration changes (step **906**). The process terminates thereafter.

(89) With reference next to FIG. **10**, a flowchart or a process for executing configuration changes is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in the flowchart in FIG. **10** is an example of one implementation for step **708** in FIG. **7** in which configuration changes are executed on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request.

(90) As depicted, the approved web resource publication request is converted into an API call appropriate to the backend server (step **1002**). In the illustrative embodiment, the API call may be a Virtual IP Address (VIP) API call required to execute the configuration change. The VIP API call is sent to the VIP server, which executes the configuration changes (step **1004**). The process terminates thereafter.

(91) With reference next to FIG. **11**, a flowchart or a process for executing configuration changes is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in the flowchart in FIG. **11** is an example of one implementation for step **708** in FIG. **7** in which configuration changes are executed on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request.

(92) As depicted, the approved web resource publication request is converted into an API call appropriate to the backend server (step **1102**). In the illustrative embodiment, the API call may be a CERT API call required to execute the configuration change. The CERT API call is sent to the certificate store, which executes the configuration changes (step **1104**). The process terminates thereafter.

(93) With reference next to FIG. **12**, a flowchart or a process for executing configuration changes is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in the flowchart in FIG. **12** is an example of one implementation for step **708** in FIG. **7** in which configuration changes are executed on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request.

(94) As depicted, the approved web resource publication request is converted into an API call appropriate to the backend server (step **1202**). In the illustrative embodiment, the API call may be a domain name services (DNS) API call, required to execute the configuration change. The DNS API call is sent to the DNS server, which executes the configuration changes (step **1204**). The process terminates thereafter.

(95) With reference next to FIG. **13**, a flowchart or a process for executing configuration changes is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in the flowchart in FIG. **13** is an example of one implementation for step **708** in FIG. **7** in which configuration changes are executed on a number of backend servers via an application programming interface (API) call in response to the web resource publication request.

(96) As depicted, the approved web resource publication request is converted into an API call appropriate to the backend server (step **1302**). In the illustrative embodiment, the API call may be a firewall API call, required to execute the configuration change. The firewall API call is sent to the firewall server, which executes the configuration changes (step **1304**). The process terminates thereafter.

(97) Turning now to FIG. **14**, an illustration of a block diagram of a data processing system is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Data processing system **1400** may be used to implement one or more computers shown in FIG. **1** (e.g., client devices **110** and servers **104**, **106**) and application development environment **200** in FIG. **2**. In this illustrative example, data processing system **1400** includes communications framework **1402**, which provides communications between processor unit **1404**, memory **1406**, persistent storage **1408**, communications unit **1410**, input/output unit **1412**, and display **1414**. In this example, communications framework **1402** may take the form of a bus system.

(98) Processor unit **1404** serves to execute instructions for software that may be loaded into memory **1406**. Processor unit **1404** may be a number of processors, a multi-processor core, or some other type of processor, depending on the particular implementation. In an embodiment, processor unit **1404** comprises one or more conventional general-purpose central processing units (CPUs). In an alternate embodiment, processor unit **1404** comprises one or more graphical processing units (GPUs).

(99) Memory **1406** and persistent storage **1408** are examples of storage devices **1416**. A storage device is any piece of hardware that is capable of storing information, such as, for example, without limitation, at least one of data, program code in functional form, or other suitable information either on a temporary basis, a permanent basis, or both on a temporary basis and a permanent basis. Storage devices **1416** may also be referred to as computer-readable storage devices in these illustrative examples. Memory **1406**, in these examples, may be, for example, a

random access memory or any other suitable volatile or non-volatile storage device. Persistent storage **1408** may take various forms, depending on the particular implementation.

(100) For example, persistent storage **1408** may contain one or more components or devices. For example, persistent storage **1408** may be a hard drive, a flash memory, a rewritable optical disk, a rewritable magnetic tape, or some combination of the above. The media used by persistent storage **1408** also may be removable. For example, a removable hard drive may be used for persistent storage **1408**. Communications unit **1410**, in these illustrative examples, provides for communications with other data processing systems or devices. In these illustrative examples, communications unit **1410** is a network interface card.

(101) Input/output unit **1412** allows for input and output of data with other devices that may be connected to data processing system **1400**. For example, input/output unit **1412** may provide a connection for user input through at least one of a keyboard, a mouse, or some other suitable input device. Further, input/output unit **1412** may send output to a printer. Display **1414** provides a mechanism to display information to a user.

(102) Instructions for at least one of the operating system, applications, or programs may be located in storage devices **1416**, which are in communication with processor unit **1404** through communications framework **1402**. The processes of the different embodiments may be performed by processor unit **1404** using computer-implemented instructions, which may be located in a memory, such as memory **1406**.

(103) These instructions are referred to as program code, computer-usable program code, or computer-readable program code that may be read and executed by a processor in processor unit **1404**. The program code in the different embodiments may be embodied on different physical or computer-readable storage media, such as memory **1406** or persistent storage **1408**.

(104) Program code **1418** is located in a functional form on computer-readable media **1420** that is selectively removable and may be loaded onto or transferred to data processing system **1400** for execution by processor unit **1404**. Program code **1418** and computer-readable media **1420** form computer program product **1422** in these illustrative examples. In one example, computer-readable media **1420** may be computer-readable storage media **1424** or computer-readable signal media **1426**.

(105) In these illustrative examples, computer-readable storage media **1424** is a physical or tangible storage device used to store program code **1418** rather than a medium that propagates or transmits program code **1418**. Alternatively, program code **1418** may be transferred to data processing system **1400** using computer-readable signal media **1426**.

(106) Computer-readable signal media **1426** may be, for example, a propagated data signal containing program code **1418**. For example, computer-readable signal media **1426** may be at least one of an electromagnetic signal, an optical signal, or any other suitable type of signal. These signals may be transmitted over at least one of communications links, such as wireless communications links, optical fiber cable, coaxial cable, a wire, or any other suitable type of communications link.

(107) The different components illustrated for data processing system **1400** are not meant to provide architectural limitations to the manner in which different embodiments may be implemented. The different illustrative embodiments may be implemented in a data processing system including components in addition to or in place of those illustrated for data processing system **1400**. Other components shown in FIG. **14** can be varied from the illustrative examples shown. The different embodiments may be implemented using any hardware device or system capable of running program code **1418**.

(108) As used herein, the phrase “a number” means one or more. The phrase “at least one of”, when used with a list of items, means different combinations of one or more of the listed items may be used, and only one of each item in the list may be needed. In other words, “at least one of” means any combination of items and number of items may be used from the list, but not all of the

items in the list are required. The item may be a particular object, a thing, or a category.

(109) For example, without limitation, “at least one of item A, item B, or item C” may include item A, item A and item B, or item C. This example also may include item A, item B, and item C or item B and item C. Of course, any combinations of these items may be present. In some illustrative examples, “at least one of” may be, for example, without limitation, two of item A; one of item B; and ten of item C; four of item B and seven of item C; or other suitable combinations.

(110) The illustrative embodiments provide method for predicting changes in customer demand. The method comprises collecting subscription data for a number of customers at specified time intervals, wherein each customer is subscribed to one of a number of defined bundles of services. The method further comprises determining any changes in customer bundle subscriptions during a given time interval, and determining metrics for defined customer tasks for subscribed services during the given time interval. From this data, the method simultaneously models, via multimodal multi-task learning, bundle subscription change events and time-to-event for each bundle subscription change. The method then predicts, according to the modeling, types and timing of changes in customer bundle subscriptions based on customer service activities. By predicting both the types of changes in bundles subscriptions and the timing of those changes, the illustrative embodiments allow proactive steps to be taken to assist customers in making changes or to mitigate negative changes. Such proactive steps might comprise targeted marketing or incentive to customers or speeding up changes to bundle subscriptions. The anticipatory, proactive steps can provide cost and time savings for both customers and service providers.

(111) The flowcharts and block diagrams in the different depicted embodiments illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of some possible implementations of apparatuses and methods in an illustrative embodiment. In this regard, each block in the flowcharts or block diagrams may represent at least one of a module, a segment, a function, or a portion of an operation or step. For example, one or more of the blocks may be implemented as program code.

(112) In some alternative implementations of an illustrative embodiment, the function or functions noted in the blocks may occur out of the order noted in the figures. For example, in some cases, two blocks shown in succession may be performed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be performed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. Also, other blocks may be added in addition to the illustrated blocks in a flowchart or block diagram.

(113) The description of the different illustrative embodiments has been presented for purposes of illustration and description and is not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments in the form disclosed. The different illustrative examples describe components that perform actions or operations. In an illustrative embodiment, a component may be configured to perform the action or operation described. For example, the component may have a configuration or design for a structure that provides the component an ability to perform the action or operation that is described in the illustrative examples as being performed by the component. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art. Further, different illustrative embodiments may provide different features as compared to other desirable embodiments. The embodiment or embodiments selected are chosen and described in order to best explain the principles of the embodiments, the practical application, and to enable others of ordinary skill in the art to understand the disclosure for various embodiments with various modifications as are suited to the particular use contemplated.

Claims

1. A system, comprising: one or more processors, coupled with memory, to: receive a request to publish a resource on a digital repository; present, via a user interface, an aspect of the request; receive, via the user interface, an input subsequent to presenting the aspect of the request; determine, based on the input, that a format of the request is valid; cause, responsive to

determination that the format of the request is valid, an execution of a test on the request, wherein the test comprises to: convert the request to at least one application programming interface (API) call; receive, responsive to transmission of the at least one API call, at least one API response that corresponds to a result of execution of the at least one API call; and determine, using the at least one API response, a status of the resource; and send the status of the resource to a computing device.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one API response includes a first format selected based on a backend server successfully implementing a configuration change of the request, and wherein the at least one API response includes a second format selected based on the backend server unsuccessfully implementing the configuration change.

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors further: generate information associated with a first configuration change of the request; store, in a database, the information associated with the first configuration change; and update, responsive to receipt of at least one second API response, the information associated with the first configuration change to reflect a second configuration change.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the resource includes at least one of: a uniform resource locator (URL); a uniform resource identifier (URI); a service; or a subscription.

5. The system of claim 1, wherein the request includes at least one of: a request to create the resource; a request to modify the resource; a request to view the resource; a request for workflow approval of the resource; or a request to delete the resource.

6. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one API call includes at least one of: a web service API; a Firewall API; a certificate API; a VIP API; and a DNS API.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein the request is received from the computing device, and wherein the request is instantiated by at least one of: one or more interactions with a web browser presented by the computing device; or a programmatic API call transmitted by the computing device.

8. The system of claim 1, wherein the format of the request includes at least one of: a URL name; a service name; a LDAP name; a server identifier; a VIP identifier; or a port number.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors further: cause, via an API call to a server, execution of a configuration change of the request; or cause, via an API call to a platform, execution of the configuration change of the request.

10. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors further: execute the test; or cause the computing device, that is remote from the one or more processors, to execute the test.

11. A method, comprising: receiving, by one or more processing circuits, a request to publish a resource on a digital repository; presenting, by the one or more processing circuits, via a user interface, an aspect of the request; receiving, by the one or more processing circuits, via the user interface, an input subsequent to presenting the aspect of the request; determining, by the one or more processing circuits, based on the input, that a format of the request is valid; causing, by the one or more processing circuits, responsive to determining that the format of the request is valid, an execution of a test on the request, wherein the test comprises: converting the request to at least one application programming interface (API) call; receiving, responsive to transmitting the at least one API call, at least one API response which represents a result of execution of the at least one API call; and determining, using the at least one API response, a status of the resource; and sending, by the one or more processing circuits, the status of the resource to a computing device.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the at least one API response includes a first format selected based on a backend server successfully implementing a configuration change of the request, and wherein the at least one API response includes a second format selected based on the backend server unsuccessfully implementing the configuration change.

13. The method of claim 11, further comprising: generating, by the one or more processing circuits, information associated with a first configuration change of the request; storing, by the one or more processing circuits, in a database, the information associated with the first configuration change;

and updating, by the one or more processing circuits, responsive to receiving at least one second API response, the information associated with the first configuration change to reflect a second configuration change.

14. The method of claim 11, wherein the resource includes at least one of: a uniform resource locator (URL); a uniform resource identifier (URI); a service; or a subscription.

15. The method of claim 11, wherein the request includes at least one of: a request to create the resource; a request to modify the resource; a request to view the resource; a request for workflow approval of the resource; or a request to delete the resource.

16. The method of claim 11, wherein the at least one API call includes at least one of: a web service API; a Firewall API; a certificate API; a VIP API; and a DNS API.

17. The method of claim 11, wherein the request is received from the computing device, and wherein the request is instantiated by at least one of: one or more interactions with a web browser presented by the computing device; or a programmatic API call transmitted by the computing device.

18. The method of claim 11, wherein the format of the request includes at least one of: a URL name; a service name; a LDAP name; a server identifier; a VIP identifier; or a port number.

19. A non-transitory computer readable storage media having instructions stored thereon that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to implement operations comprising: receiving a request to publish a resource on a digital repository; presenting, via a user interface, an aspect of the request; receiving, via the user interface, an input subsequent to presenting the aspect of the request; determining, based on the input, that a format of the request is valid; causing, responsive to determination that the format of the request is valid, an execution of a test on the request, wherein the test comprises: converting the request to at least one application programming interface (API) call; receiving, responsive to transmitting the at least one API call, at least one API response which represents a result of execution of the at least one API call; and determining, using the at least one API response, a status of the resource; and sending the status of the resource to a computing device.

20. The non-transitory computer readable storage media of claim 19, the operations further comprising: receiving, via the input, an indication that the format of the request is valid; and determining, based on the indication, that the format of the request is valid.
